Operation Stone Ford (hard)

F/A-18C Hornet · 1–2 players · Caucasus · close air support, troops in contact · cold start and recovery aboard CVN-74

First wave	**10:48 local**	**Defend**	Blue's bridgehead at Ganmukhuri, on the Inguri
Attack	4 waves, 21 vehicles, from the north-west	**Weapons**	Maverick F, GBU-12, Mk-20 Rockeye
Control	AXEMAN, ground JTAC, Type 1	**Lost if**	3 vehicles reach the village
Mother	CVN-74 · 127.5 · TACAN 74X · ICLS 11	**Support**	ARCO, MAGIC, CHEVY on fleet defence only

Situation

CAG's verdict on Narrow Gate was short: "Your plan didn't stop them, and I can't spare more for it." The lead battalion reached the Inguri at full strength. CHEVY stays on fleet defence. MAGIC will commit it only against threats to the boat, never to the Inguri. You have your section and ARCO. Win this and the plan's failure is forgiven. Lose it and the bridges are gone.

What is left of the battalion is attacking Blue's bridgehead at Ganmukhuri, on the north bank of the Inguri, which covers the bridges. Blue is holding the village with light infantry who are almost out of anti-armour weapons. If the bridgehead falls, the bridges go with it.

The attack comes from the north-west in 4 waves, 21 vehicles in all:

- Wave 1 moves at 10:48: 3× BMP-2, 2× T-72.
- Wave 2 moves at 10:53: 3× T-72, 2× BMP-2, ZSU-23-4.
- Wave 3 moves at 10:58: 3× BMP-2, BTR-80, SA-8.
- Wave 4 moves at 11:03: 2× T-72, 2× BMP-2, SA-13.

Two MiG-29s are expected over the Inguri at about 10:42, before the first wave moves, and nobody is coming to deal with them for you. Bring the AIM-9Xs and the AMRAAM into the fight if you have to.

Mission

Break the attack before it reaches the village. The bridges are lost if 3 vehicles get through.

Control

AXEMAN is a ground JTAC with the infantry, and this is **Type 1** control: he has to see you on every pass. Call IN from inside 8 nm, with a line of sight to the village, or he will tell you to CONTINUE without a clearance. You get a new 9-line for every target group, and each one has to be read back.

Final attack headings are **020–070 or 200–250**: along the front, never toward the village. Targets within 1000 m of friendlies are danger close, and AXEMAN gives his initials in the 9-line and the readback. Any impact within 150 m of friendlies is fratricide. A vehicle that reaches the village edge, 800 m from the bridges, is through. Red opens fire once it is inside about 3 km.

What happens next

This is the last mission on this branch of the campaign.

Result	Needs	What it means
Success	No more than 1 vehicle through, and no fratricide	The bridgehead holds. The Red advance dies at the Inguri
Partial	2 to 2 through, or any fratricide	The bridgehead holds, at a cost
Failure	3 or more through	The bridges at Ganmukhuri are lost. Blue falls back behind the Inguri
A jet lost	Any result	If the pilot ejected over land, also fly **Operation_Sandy_Lift_Inguri.miz**

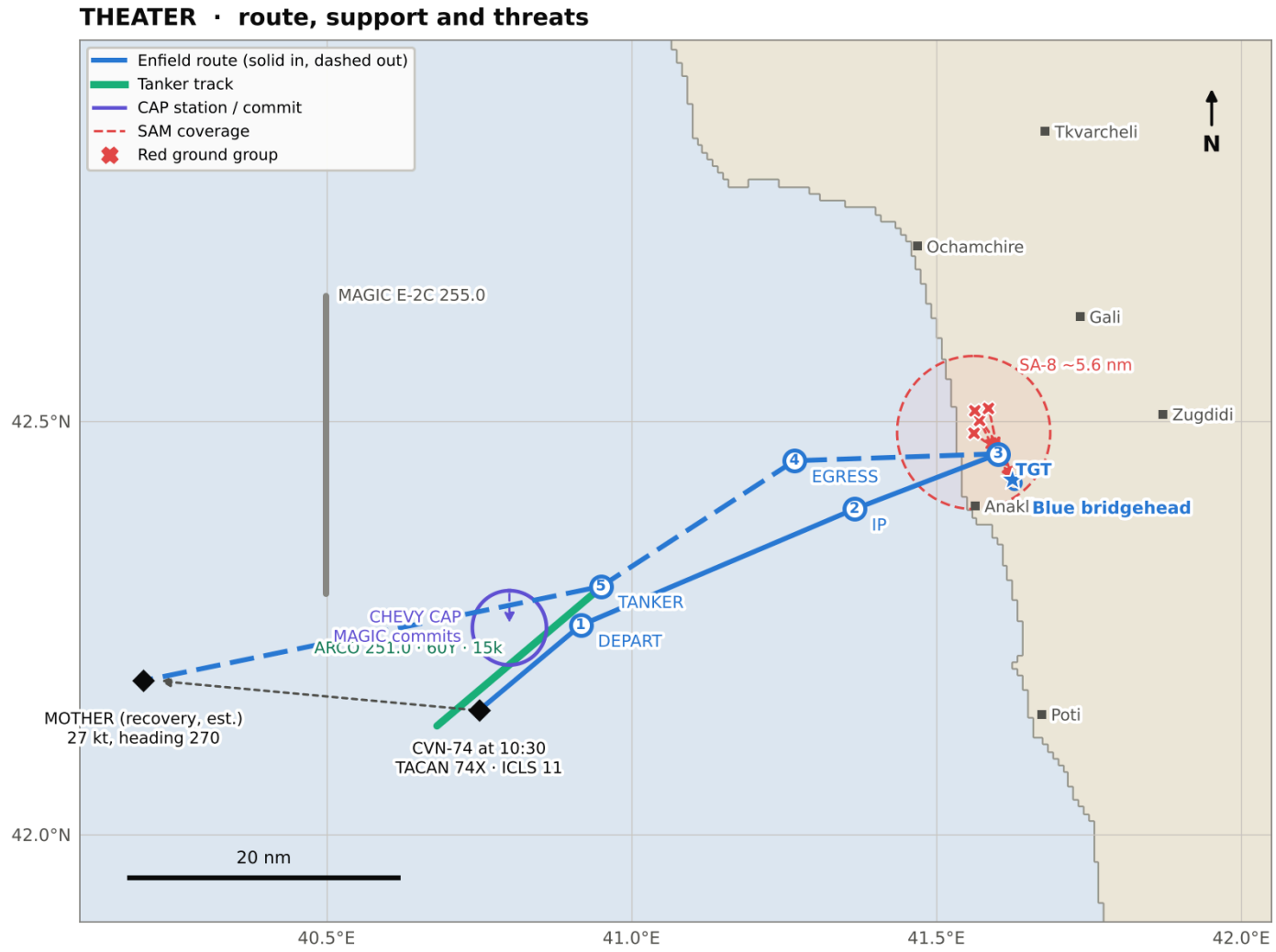
Vehicles still advancing when your last jet lands count as through. Secondary objective, **clean recovery**: every jet that launches traps aboard Mother with at least about 2,000 lb of fuel, and nobody is lost.

1 or 2 players, cold start on the deck. Enfield 1-1 is flyable in single player.

Key times

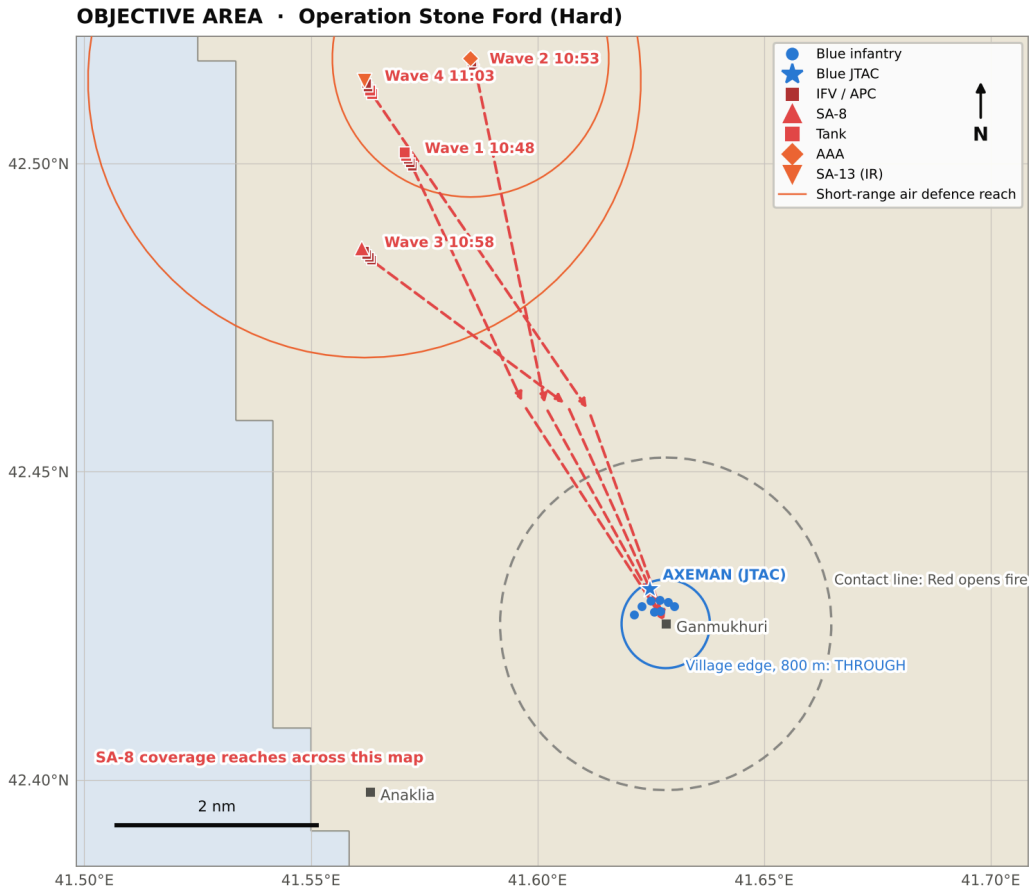
Event	Local
Mission start, cold on the deck	10:30
Red MiG-29 pair over the Inguri	10:42
Wave 1 moves (5 vehicles)	10:48
Wave 2 moves (6 vehicles)	10:53
Wave 3 moves (5 vehicles)	10:58
Wave 4 moves (5 vehicles)	11:03

MAP 1



Coastline is approximate (about 1 km resolution). Courses are true. MOTHER is the carrier's estimated position at recovery. She steams west at 27 kt, so trust TACAN 74X over the waypoint.

MAP 2



Control: Type 1, AXEMAN

Step	You (F10)	AXEMAN
1	Check in	Situation, threats and game plan
2	Ready to copy 9-line	A 9-line on the group closest to the village, with live coordinates
3	Read back 4, 6 and restrictions	Readback correct. A new 9-line needs a new readback
4	IN, heading 020–070 or 200–250, inside 8 nm	CLEARED HOT, CONTINUE (he can't see you), or ABORT with the reason
5	Ten seconds, then Spot	Laser on from AXEMAN's position, code 1688
6	OFF	BDA: impacts, closest miss, destroyed, through, still coming

Times and route

- Wave 1 moves at 10:48 local (5 vehicles).
- Wave 2 moves at 10:53 local (6 vehicles).
- Wave 3 moves at 10:58 local (5 vehicles).
- Wave 4 moves at 11:03 local (5 vehicles).
- Red fighters: 10:42 local.

WP	Name	Coordinates	Alt	Leg	Course
0	CVN-74 (deck)	N 42°09.000′ E 040°45.000′	deck		
1	DEPART	N 42°15.184′ E 040°55.011′	5,000 ft	9.7 nm	050°
2	IP	N 42°23.619′ E 041°21.959′	18,000 ft	21.7 nm	067°
3	TGT	N 42°27.628′ E 041°36.108′	18,000 ft	11.2 nm	069°
4	EGRESS	N 42°27.125′ E 041°16.050′	18,000 ft	14.8 nm	268°
5	TANKER	N 42°18.000′ E 040°57.000′	15,000 ft	16.8 nm	237°
6	MOTHER (land)	N 42°11.163′ E 040°11.990′	deck	34.0 nm	259°

The IP is over the water: hold there until AXEMAN has a target for you. TGT marks the attack axis north-west of the bridgehead.

Loadout

Both jets: 2× AGM-65F Maverick, 2× GBU-12, 2× Mk-20 Rockeye, LITENING, 2× AIM-9X, AIM-120C, tank.

Station	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
1-1	AIM-9X	AGM-65F Maverick	2 x GBU-12	LITENING pod	FPU-8A tank 330 gal	AIM-120C	2 x Mk-20 Rockeye	AGM-65F Maverick	AIM-9X
1-2	AIM-9X	AGM-65F Maverick	2 x GBU-12	LITENING pod	FPU-8A tank 330 gal	AIM-120C	2 x Mk-20 Rockeye	AGM-65F Maverick	AIM-9X

Comms and navigation

Callsign	Role	Frequency	Notes
MOTHER	CVN-74 John C. Stennis	127.5 AM	TACAN 74X STN · ICLS 11
ENFIELD 1-1, 1-2	You	251.0 AM	Flight frequency, shared with ARCO
ARCO	S-3B tanker, 15,000 ft	251.0 AM	TACAN 60Y
MAGIC	E-2C, controls CHEVY and UZI	255.0 AM	
AXEMAN	Ground JTAC with the infantry	F10 menu	Laser 1688
CHEVY	2× F/A-18C, fleet defence only	MAGIC commits	Threats to the boat only
UZI	2× F/A-18C alert-5 on Mother	Via MAGIC	About 12 min to the CAP station

F10 radio menu: Stone Ford

Item	What it does
Axeman: battle status	Destroyed, through, the closest group, the next wave

Item	What it does
Request CAP cover	Refused: CAG has CHEVY on fleet defence
JTAC Axeman > 1, 2, 3	Check in, 9-line, read back
JTAC Axeman > Enfield 1-x > IN	Type 1 clearance request with your current heading
JTAC Axeman > Enfield 1-x > Ten seconds, Spot	Laser on, confirm the spot
JTAC Axeman > Enfield 1-x > OFF	BDA for your last pass
JTAC Axeman > Terminate	Laser off
Mission summary now	Outcome on demand